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analysis is, for example, the case accounts convey an approach of amazement. They afford any aspirant a glimpse into other analysts' consulting rooms and into the different and kindred ways in which psychoanalyses proceed and how their progression is portrayed. Reading these very different cases draws the experienced analyst, like a kind of involved voyeur, into all these dyadic relationships. It activates his own basic assumptions, placing him at an almost supervisory distance ('I would do this straight away or not that way'), leaving him at once astonished, critical and in awe. This book is an exciting challenge and – if one accepts it – a decidedly enriching addition to a skilled craft!

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The feeling brain: Selected papers on neuropsychanalysis

by **Mark Solms**

Karnac Books, London, 2015; 240 pp; £23.04

One hundred and twenty years ago, Freud commenced his transition from neurologist to psychoanalyst and furnished us with his 'Project for a scientific psychology' of the mind. So began a necessary divergence from the dominant biological doctrine of the day. *The feeling brain* attempts to provide us with an accessible bridge back, between these two pursuits and between brain and mind, through an exploration of the various facets of the emerging discipline of neuropsychanalysis. Solms and colleagues seek, in doing so, not to "prove Freud right or wrong but rather to finish the job he started; namely of introducing the psyche to the field of neuropsychology".

The collected papers presented together raise to our awareness the potential for that process to become more fully realized, with the trajectory of discussion focused first on neurological and then psychiatric conditions before the implications for the understanding of normal mental functioning are considered. Through this broad arc, detractors and naysayers are anticipated and at points, countered. The fact that their identities move between neuroscientist, behaviorist and even psychoanalyst, relates no doubt to the discipline of neuropsychanalysis itself, as not wholly represented within any of the other fields. In considering the place for psychoanalytic understanding, Solms limits himself almost exclusively to those findings of Freud, drawing upon a similar capacity to integrate these different fields into something new. That he writes, as a result, in a manner that

approaches the style of Freud might offer some comfort through this, at times, foreign landscape.

As a starting point, the mind is considered as both subject and object. Neuropsychanalysis places itself as a link to the findings of the 'science of the mind as an object with those of the mind as a subject'. Initial discussions are given over to the historical, philosophical and scientific foundations to neuropsychanalysis, together offered as argument against a reductionist solution to the mind-body problem. Psychoanalysis does not, we might agree, simply study the emergent properties of the brain as epiphenomena of a biological 'reality'. The difference between psychoanalysis and neuroscience instead, Solms holds, rests upon the perceptual surface that we use, with the former directing observations internally and the latter to the external. In this, his theory of 'dual-aspect monism', both disciplines merit an important position, with neuropsychanalysis offering the potential for correlation between the two; a view stated at the outset and emphasized at regular intervals. Solms hopes through this endeavor to redress a perceived imbalance; specifically that neuroscientific research has not historically recognized as important the nature of the subjective experience. He notes the emergence of a new platform from which this work can fruitfully take place, citing advances through the last century in affective and social neuroscience, neuropsychology and attachment theory as central in the relating of mind to brain.

Accounts of discrete neurological conditions provide a fascinating and grounded account of therapeutic work within the developing interface between psychoanalysis and cognitive neuroscience. Firstly, in his discussion of patients with right hemispheric brain injury, Solms explores resultant loss of bodily functioning as a profound narcissistic wound, with associated feelings stemming from dependency upon the affected body part, perceived as a lost object. Despite suffering broadly similar insults to their brain that are considered as breaching the integrity of the body ego in this way, however, he discovers radically different emotional symptoms and groups of defensive reactions. Their origins are traced to unique, earlier psychological traumata that may only be understood psychologically. Again, then, the argument is underlined that mental functions can never be found inside neuroanatomical structures, but may instead be said to exist between them such that one cannot be reduced to the other. In short, the mind is recognized as being no less real than the brain.

Secondly, a case of Korsakoff's syndrome highlights how some of the meta-psychological abstractions derived from Freud's works might begin to find their correlates in anatomical structures. The amnesia and tendency to confabulation is well known in Korsakoff's syndrome to be linked to damage to an area of the brain just in front of the third ventricle. What is newly expounded, however, is the dynamic interplay resulting when the reality-monitoring part of the mind is weakened in this manner, leaving something to fill the gap in memory deficit. The resultant confabulation is not meaningless at all, we find, but symbolically connected and conforming to all the principal characteristics of the unconscious. The hope is proffered that in studying further neurological syndromes that also display a release of aspects of primary process functioning, we might not only make further

links between psychoanalytic theory and physical correlates, but also understand more of the composite elements to secondary process functioning. Thus Solms and colleagues argue, under the umbrella term of neuropsychanalysis, in favor of the two disciplines being mutually enriching.

Consideration given to the phenomena of depression and addiction extends the suggested territory for neuropsychanalytic enquiry, with the link between psychiatric conditions and physiological correlates also being highlighted. Extrapolating from the findings of animal-based studies of emotional brain development within affective neuroscience, the prevailing current psychiatric understanding about the aetiology of these disorders is challenged. Depression, viewed as the pathological state of mourning first set down by Freud, is contextualized in relation to the now known physiological processes of separation distress encountered during the absence of an attachment figure. A premature shutting down of seeking behaviour aimed at recapturing the lost object accounts for depressive symptoms both physiologically *and* psychoanalytically. Under such examination, serotonin depletion is relegated from causative to a correlate of depression.

Correlation is found in studying addiction by this same method. Addiction is discussed as a failure to transition from auto-erotic self-soothing to mastery of the real world and attainment of a secure love object. Viewed as an object-less state akin to masturbation, the parallel voiced first by Freud is again invoked. Affective neuroscience additionally now highlights that the physiological processes involved in seeking the lost object may become blunted. Individuals then come to learn, erroneously, that substances generating a physiological reward may enable them to gain access to further pleasurable experiences and lost attachment figures. Substituting addiction for the lost objects of sexual and social interaction offers up again a focus to successful treatment and so we glean, through Solms' discussion of the disorders of depression and addiction, the potential fruits of a marriage between psychoanalytic and physiological understandings. Together, directing investigation into the core basis of each disorder offers more effective integrated interventions to be realized.

In turning finally to dreams and to the subject of consciousness, we are offered examples of how neuropsychanalysis may be usefully applied to normal mental life. Solms flies the flag for the place of psychoanalysis as equal partner to contemporary neuroscience. Some interesting findings emerge. Freud's inferences, derived of course through the 'subjective' method of analysis, about the causes and functioning of dreams appear compatible with and supported by the latest objective neuroscientific research. For instance, the close link outlined between those brain structures responsible for dreaming and those responsible for emotions and motivation is consistent with the notion that dreams are triggered by an arousing stimulus, giving expression to instinctual drives. In keeping with Freud's concept of regression within the psychic apparatus during dreaming there does also appear to be a neuropsychological correlate in the now known movement of activity from motor system (dorsolateral frontal cortex) to perceptual system (occipito-temporo-parietal area) of the brain. These recent neuroscientific findings arise on the back of Freud's dream theory having been con-

sidered previously debunked. This not only speaks to Freud's own genius in being ahead of his time (and in this area until recently, of our time too), but also to the historically acrimonious relationship between cognitive science and psychoanalysis that now has the potential to begin a useful working through.

In dealing with the subject of consciousness, the role of neuropsychanalysis in testing Freud's theories against the evidence base of neuroscience is brought into sharp focus. This is not to assume a biased function that serves to vindicate psychoanalytic theory, however, but instead to extrapolate from and in some cases overturn previous understandings. Freud's famous maxim that the ego is first and foremost a bodily ego gains new ground through, most notably, the link to affective neuroscience. Here higher cortical external and phylogenetically older internal body representational systems are discussed, with the former corresponding to the ego and the latter to the id. Of special interest is the proposition then arising for an affective consciousness, generated by the id and forming a background state of being. The id is considered conscious. Moreover, the ego is itself considered unconscious, transforming this 'affective consciousness' into mental solids, or object representations, to establish (master) predictions about external reality and reduce the experience of surprise and uncertainty about reality. These predictions can then be rendered unconscious.

Solms considers cognitive neuroscience as 'neurotic' in having failed to recognize and give space to the importance of the affective dimension of the mind. To do otherwise, it must allow itself to be surprised by reality and generate a more suited 'mental solid'. I add to this the need to establish a priori the capacity to endure not knowing, to inhabit a state of 'negative capability'. This book is also extending the same invitation to psychoanalysis, in the hope of a more creative engagement with the reality of both brain and mind. As Solms concludes, what could be more fascinating than that?

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The private life: Why we remain in the dark

by **Josh Cohen**

Granta Books, London, 2013; 223 pp; £9.99

The private life: Our everyday self in an age of intrusion

by **Josh Cohen**

Counterpoint, Berkeley, CA, 2015; 256 pp; £26.00

You are two people: yourself and someone else. This central split in the human mind and its consequences for current culture are the focus of Josh